

The system includes built-in commands for controlling Windows—allowing you to start, switch between, and close applications. You can use commands such as “Start Notepad”, and “Switch to Calculator.” You can also control screen elements through commands such as “Open”.

The dictation features allow you to convert voice to text, while edit controls are used to insert and correct dictated elements. You can also speak commands to select text, navigate inside a document, and make edits.

The system also offers text feedback keeping you in touch with what the system is doing, and providing necessary instructions. If the system is unsure of a word that you have spoken, it can also ask for clarification—offering you to choose the right instance from multiple possibilities. Finally, the system is learning and adapting to your voice and environment to improve accuracy over time.

4.7 Tablet interface

Windows Vista also offers handwriting recognition to those who either use a tablet with their computers, or use a Tablet PC. These tablet features are offered in the Ultimate and Business versions of Vista and come preloaded into any Tablet PC laptops. For those with a Wacom tablet, or similar solutions—these features add another layer of interaction with the computer. You can now write directly into ink-capable applications such as OneNote and Evernote, even Outlook and Microsoft Journal. Windows Vista indexes your handwritten notes allowing you to search and sort your handwritten data, just as easily as data traditionally typed through keyboard. Handwriting input is done through a Tablet Input Panel (TIP) which is now an integral part of Vista—TIP can also dock and hide to the edges, making it both accessible and out of sight. TIP can be used to enter handwritten text into any program or text box which takes text entry. The manner in which the program enters the information will depend on whether it is